

Policy on Narcotics, Psychotropics, Chemotherapy and Radio-pharmaceuticals

«Hospital Name»

Document control

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Prepared by	Pharmacy In-Charge Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Reviewed by	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved by	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

A blank marked _____ must be completed before issue.

Statement of intent

Narcotic drugs, psychotropic substances, chemotherapeutic agents, and radio-pharmaceuticals are prescribed only by appropriate caregivers, stored securely, prepared only by qualified personnel, and every use is recorded and disposed of in line with applicable law.

1. Purpose

This policy explains how «Hospital Name» handles narcotic drugs, psychotropic substances, chemotherapeutic agents, and radio-pharmaceuticals safely — how they're prescribed, stored, prepared, administered, recorded, and disposed of.

This policy does not cover general medication prescription, storage, or dispensing in detail — those are covered in other hospital policies.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all staff involved in prescribing, storing, preparing, administering, or disposing of narcotic drugs, psychotropic substances, chemotherapeutic agents, and radio-pharmaceuticals at «Hospital Name».

3. Policy standards

«Hospital Name» handles narcotic drugs, psychotropic substances, chemotherapeutic agents, and radio-pharmaceuticals under written guidance developed in line with applicable law, prescribed only by appropriately authorised caregivers, stored securely, and prepared and administered only by qualified personnel. Usage, administration, and disposal are recorded and comply with applicable statutory requirements.

Staff follow the written guidance below and keep the records it requires.

4. Non-negotiable rules

1. Do not operate without written guidance, developed in line with applicable law, covering how narcotic drugs, psychotropic substances, chemotherapeutic agents, and radio-pharmaceuticals are handled.
2. Do not let anyone other than a designated or privileged medical officer prescribe a narcotic drug, do not let anyone without demonstrated knowledge and competency prescribe chemotherapy, and do not let anyone other than a statutorily authorised caregiver prescribe a radio-pharmaceutical.
3. Do not leave narcotic drugs or psychotropic substances unsecured, and do not issue them without a register entry and an authorised prescriber.
4. Do not leave chemotherapeutic agents accessible to unauthorised personnel, and do not store or label radio-pharmaceuticals outside applicable regulatory guidelines.
5. Do not prepare or administer chemotherapeutic agents or radio-pharmaceuticals without qualified, specially trained personnel and the required preparation conditions, including a class II biosafety cabinet with appropriate personal protective equipment for chemotherapy preparation.
6. Strict inventory control is mandatory for all narcotic, psychotropic, and high-risk agents; usage, administration, wastage, and disposal of each such agent must be recorded individually in accordance with applicable statutory requirements — no entry may be omitted or consolidated with another.

5. What we do

5.1 Follow written guidance developed in line with applicable law

Written guidance, developed in consonance with applicable local and national regulations and guidelines, is implemented for the safe use of narcotic drugs, psychotropic substances, chemotherapeutic agents, and radio-pharmaceuticals. It could address all the requirements in this policy in one document.

5.2 Ensure prescription by appropriate caregivers

Narcotic drugs are prescribed only by a designated or privileged medical officer. Chemotherapy is prescribed only by someone with the knowledge to monitor and treat its adverse effects — preferably a medical oncologist, or another doctor trained and competent in chemotherapy.

Radio-pharmaceuticals are prescribed only by a caregiver authorised under applicable regulations.

5.3 Store these medications securely

Narcotic drugs are stored securely in line with applicable regulatory requirements, with security measures that prevent diversion and abuse. Chemotherapeutic agents are accessible only to authorised personnel. Radio-pharmaceuticals are labelled and stored following applicable regulatory guidelines. It's preferable to store all of these separately from other medications.

5.4 Prepare and administer only through qualified personnel

Personnel preparing and administering chemotherapeutic drugs have received special training for it. A class II biosafety cabinet — preferably class IIA — with appropriate personal protective equipment is used for preparing or mixing chemotherapeutic drugs. Radio-pharmaceuticals are prepared and administered only by an authorised caregiver.

5.5 Keep proper records of usage and disposal

Strict inventory control is kept for narcotic drugs, psychotropic substances, chemotherapeutic agents, and radio-pharmaceuticals. Records of the usage, administration, wastage, and disposal of narcotic drugs are kept in line with applicable statutory requirements. Disposal of all these medications follows applicable statutory requirements and, where relevant, the manufacturer's recommendation.

6. Stop-work authority

Do not prepare or administer chemotherapeutic agents or radio-pharmaceuticals without qualified personnel and the required preparation conditions.

Do not leave narcotic drugs or psychotropic substances unsecured, or issue them without the required register entry and authorised prescriber.

Stop-work applies to preparation, issue, and administration of these classes. Immediate life-saving analgesia or anaesthesia using a controlled drug follows the documented emergency-controlled-drug rules and is entered in the register the same shift.

The person who stops tells the Pharmacy In-Charge and the Medical Superintendent the same shift. Refusing unsafe handling of these agents is not a disciplinary matter.

7. Governance and responsibility

Role	Responsibility
Medical Superintendent	Accountable for ensuring this policy is resourced and implemented; receives stop-work escalations from the Pharmacy In-Charge.
Pharmacy In-Charge	Owens day-to-day implementation; maintains

	the narcotic and psychotropic register; ensures secure storage, issue controls, and inventory records; receives stop-work escalations and escalates to the Medical Superintendent.
Medical Oncologist / Trained Chemotherapy Doctor	Prescribes chemotherapy; has demonstrated knowledge to monitor and treat adverse effects; oversees chemotherapy preparation safety.
Authorised Caregiver — Radio-pharmaceuticals	Prescribes, prepares, and administers radio-pharmaceuticals under applicable regulatory authorisation; ensures regulatory storage and labelling requirements are met.
Quality Coordinator	Audits this policy; holds training records and staff acknowledgements.

8. Quality monitoring

Monitoring area	What is monitored
Written guidance	In place, developed in line with applicable law, covering prescription, storage, preparation, records, and disposal for all four drug classes.
Narcotic and psychotropic prescription authorisation	Narcotics prescribed only by a designated or privileged medical officer; prescriber category documented.
Chemotherapy prescriber authorisation	Chemotherapy prescribed only by a doctor with demonstrated knowledge and competency — preferably a medical oncologist; training or privileging records current.
Radio-pharmaceutical prescriber authorisation	Radio-pharmaceuticals prescribed only by a statutorily authorised caregiver; authorisation records current.
Narcotic and psychotropic security and issue controls	Drugs stored securely; narcotic register maintained; issue only with register entry and authorised prescriber.
Chemotherapy preparation — class II biosafety cabinet and PPE	Class II biosafety cabinet (preferably IIA) in use for preparation; appropriate PPE used; preparation staff specially trained and records current.
Radio-pharmaceutical storage and preparation	Labelled and stored per applicable regulatory guidelines; prepared and administered only by authorised caregiver.
Inventory, wastage, and disposal records	Strict inventory control; usage, administration, wastage, and disposal records in line with applicable statutory requirements.
Stop-work events	Stop-work events logged with trigger, action taken, and outcome.

9. Training and staff acknowledgement

All staff involved in prescribing, storing, preparing, administering, or disposing of narcotic drugs, psychotropic substances, chemotherapeutic agents, or radio-pharmaceuticals shall be familiar with the written guidance, prescriber-authorisation requirements, security and issue controls, preparation conditions (including class II biosafety cabinet and PPE for chemotherapy), inventory and disposal requirements, and stop-work authority in this policy.

I have read the Policy on Narcotics, Psychotropics, Chemotherapy and Radio-pharmaceuticals of «Hospital Name». I will follow the processes described.

Staff name	Designation	Signature	Date
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____

10. Distribution

This policy shall be available to the Pharmacy In-Charge, pharmacists, nurses and doctors authorised to prescribe or administer these agents, the Medical Oncologist, the authorised radio-pharmaceutical caregiver, the Medical Superintendent, and the Quality Coordinator.

11. Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Meaning
AERB	Atomic Energy Regulatory Board
CORE	Core objective element (NABH)
MOM	Management of Medication (NABH Hospitals chapter)
NABH	National Accreditation Board for Hospitals and Healthcare Providers
NDPS	Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances
OE	Objective Element (NABH)
PPE	Personal Protective Equipment

12. Traceability table

This table is an index. It is not how the policy is organised. An asterisk in the Level column means documentation of the process is required.

Objective Element	Level	Traceability to this policy
MOM.9.a	Commitment*	Sections 3 and 5.1 address written guidance developed in consonance with applicable local and national regulations and guidelines, covering all handling requirements for narcotic

		drugs, psychotropic substances, chemotherapeutic agents, and radio-pharmaceuticals.
MOM.9.b	Commitment	Section 5.2 addresses the three distinct prescriber-authorisation tiers: narcotics (designated or privileged medical officer), chemotherapy (demonstrated knowledge and competency, preferably medical oncologist), and radio-pharmaceuticals (caregiver authorised under applicable regulations). No NDPS Act section numbers or AERB rule citations are stated.
MOM.9.c	Commitment	Section 5.3 addresses secure narcotic and psychotropic storage preventing diversion and abuse, authorised-personnel-only access for chemotherapy, and regulatory-compliant labelling and storage for radio-pharmaceuticals.
MOM.9.d	Commitment	Section 5.4 addresses the class II biosafety cabinet (preferably class IIA) with appropriate PPE for chemotherapy preparation, special training of preparation personnel, and authorised-caregiver requirement for radio-pharmaceutical preparation and administration.
MOM.9.e	Commitment	Section 5.5 addresses strict inventory control and records of usage, administration, wastage, and disposal for narcotic drugs in line with applicable statutory requirements, and statutory-compliant disposal for all four drug classes.

13. Required Records/Evidence Checklist

Written guidance — MOM.9.a (Commitment*)

1. Written guidance in place, developed in line with applicable local and national regulations and guidelines, covering prescription, storage, preparation, administration, record-keeping, and disposal of narcotic drugs, psychotropic substances, chemotherapeutic agents, and radio-pharmaceuticals.
2. Date of last review and evidence that the guidance reflects current applicable statutory requirements.

Prescription by appropriate caregivers — MOM.9.b

1. List of designated or privileged medical officers authorised to prescribe narcotic drugs; narcotic prescriptions bearing authorised-prescriber identity.
2. Records confirming the chemotherapy prescriber's demonstrated knowledge and competency — for example, training records, privileging documents, or oncology credentials.
3. Authorisation document confirming the radio-pharmaceutical prescriber is authorised under applicable regulations.

Secure storage — MOM.9.c

1. Physical security measures for narcotic and psychotropic drug storage (for example, locked cabinet, restricted key access) that prevent diversion and abuse; in line with applicable regulatory requirements.
2. Access controls confirming chemotherapeutic agents are accessible only to authorised personnel.
3. Storage and labelling records for radio-pharmaceuticals confirming compliance with applicable regulatory guidelines.

Qualified preparation and administration — MOM.9.d

1. Training records for personnel preparing and administering chemotherapeutic drugs confirming special training.
2. Evidence of class II biosafety cabinet (preferably class IIA) in use for chemotherapy preparation, with appropriate PPE available and used.
3. Authorisation records confirming radio-pharmaceuticals are prepared and administered only by an authorised caregiver.

Records of usage and disposal — MOM.9.e

1. Narcotic register showing usage, administration, wastage, and disposal in line with applicable statutory requirements; cross-checked against inventory.
2. Strict inventory control records for narcotic drugs, psychotropic substances, chemotherapeutic agents, and radio-pharmaceuticals.
3. Disposal records for all four drug classes, following applicable statutory requirements and manufacturer recommendations where relevant.

14. References

1. National Accreditation Board for Hospitals and Healthcare Providers. NABH Accreditation Standards for Hospitals, 6th Edition. MOM.9.
2. Government of India. (1985).
https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/15315/1/the_narcotic_drugs_and_psychotropic_substances_act_1985.pdf Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act, 1985 (Central Act No. 61 of 1985), and the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Rules, 1985 (as amended).
3. Atomic Energy Regulatory Board, Department of Atomic Energy, Government of India. (2004). <https://www.aerb.gov.in/images/PDF/RPR2004-with-corrigendum.pdf> Atomic Energy (Radiation Protection) Rules, 2004, notified under the Atomic Energy Act, 1962.
4. Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Government of India. (2016). <https://clip.cpcb.gov.in/index.php/rule/bio-medical-waste-management-rules-2016/> Bio-Medical Waste Management Rules, 2016 (as amended).

Disclaimer

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Several requirements in this document are statutory rather than advisory — in particular those arising under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act, 1985, and applicable rules for chemotherapeutic agents and radio-pharmaceuticals as referenced for NABH MOM.9. Statutory requirements change, and State authorities impose additional or stricter conditions. «Hospital Name» is responsible for verifying the current text of any rule cited here and the conditions attached to its own authorisations and licences; this document does not constitute legal advice.

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